

Thursday, 9 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 35° 22°	BIRMINGHAM Clear 33° 20°	MANCHESTER Clear 29° 19°	GLASGOW Overcast 23° 17°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

In a truly historic decision, Ruth Ellis, the last woman to be hanged in the UK, has been granted a conditional posthumous pardon.

Ellis was executed in 1955 after being convicted of murdering her lover, David Blakely. This pardon comes decades after her death and reignites discussions around her case.

CRIME · UK
- 2

An international manhunt is now underway for a man wanted in connection with the murders of his wife and daughters.

Ndodana Mkhanyisi Tshuma is believed to have left the country via Heathrow Airport. Police are appealing for any information that could help locate him.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A neo-Nazi who planned a gun attack has been jailed following an MI5 sting operation.

Twenty-two-year-old Alfie Coleman was sentenced at the Old Bailey after being found guilty in April. This case highlights the ongoing threat from extremist groups.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A father has been convicted of murdering his four-week-old son after a night out.

Tony Bartlett was found guilty by a jury at Bristol Crown Court. It's a truly tragic and heartbreaking case.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Millions of pounds have been awarded to survivors of a 1992 UVF pub attack that tragically killed one man.

This is believed to be one of the largest payouts ever in a Troubles-related case. It brings some measure of justice decades after the event.

HISTORY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Spider-Man star Tom Holland says his role in Christopher Nolan's upcoming movie, 'The Odyssey', is a 'real pinch-me moment'.**

Holland and other cast members have been sharing their excitement for the hotly anticipated film. It sounds like it's going to be a huge release.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Tom Holland in a Christopher Nolan film? What kind of role do you think he'll play?

FILM · COMING SOON
- 2 Stars and fans have been celebrating the wedding of Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce, who tied the knot in New York on Friday.**

The A-list couple's big day attracted plenty of attention, with celebrities and sports stars spotted at the event. It sounds like quite the party!

ON AIR – What do you think was the most talked-about moment from Taylor and Travis's wedding?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK
- 3 Patrick Kielty is set to return as the host of 'The Late Late Show', describing it as 'one of the greatest gigs in the world'.**

The County Down native will be back fronting the popular chat show. It's great news for fans of his presenting style.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to seeing Patrick Kielty back on 'The Late Late Show'? Who would be your dream guest for him?

TV · COMING SOON
- 4 K-Pop sensation BTS are claiming credit for England's recent football win during their first UK show since 2019.**

The pop group, back in London, joked that they are a good luck charm for the England team. Sounds like they brought the party with them!

ON AIR – Do you think BTS are a good luck charm for England? What's your favourite BTS song?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 5 Newlyweds Kym and Tyler celebrated their wedding by dashing off to see Pitbull perform at Lytham Festival!**

After tying the knot in Warrington, the couple joined thousands of fans for the final day of the festival. What a way to start married life!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual thing you've done to celebrate your wedding or a special occasion?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 In a massive coup for women's football, London City Lionesses have signed two-time Ballon d'Or winner Alexia Putellas on a three-year deal!

This is undoubtedly one of the biggest transfers in the history of the women's game. It shows the growing ambition and investment in the sport here in the UK.

ON AIR – How big do you think this signing is for women's football in the UK? Could it inspire more top players to come over?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 British wildcard Arthur Fery is hoping to go all the way at Wimbledon, preparing for his quarter-final match against Flavio Cobolli.

Fery grew up watching matches on Centre Court and says his game is inspired by Andre Agassi. Could this be the year for a British breakthrough?

ON AIR – How far do you think Arthur Fery can go at Wimbledon? Are you backing the British wildcard?

TENNIS · UK

3 Novak Djokovic has reached the Wimbledon semi-finals after a five-set thriller against Felix Auger-Aliassime.

It was the longest Wimbledon quarter-final in history, lasting five hours and 15 minutes. He'll now face Jannik Sinner in the final four.

ON AIR – After such an epic match, do you think Djokovic has enough left in the tank to win the whole tournament?

TENNIS · UK

4 England have secured an unbeatable 2-0 lead in their T20 series against India, crushing them by 125 runs at Trent Bridge!

They bowled India out for just 76, marking a record T20 defeat for the visitors. What a dominant performance from England!

ON AIR – After such a dominant performance, how confident are you about England's chances in the rest of the series?

CRICKET · UK

5 Jordan Henderson has undergone surgery in the USA after breaking his arm during England's World Cup celebrations.

The injury happened after England's dramatic win over Mexico on Sunday. It's a real shame for Henderson, especially after such a big victory.

ON AIR – What's the craziest injury you've heard of happening during a celebration?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals the surprising comfort many find in listening to the distant rumble of a train.**
Researchers suggest this rhythmic, low-frequency sound can be strangely soothing, evoking a sense of calm and nostalgia, particularly for those living near railway lines.
- 2 The simple act of 'doodling during meetings' is being hailed as a way to boost focus and memory.**
Experts believe that light, unstructured drawing can help maintain attention and even aid in retaining information, rather than being a distraction.
- 3 Interest in 'foraging for wild berries and mushrooms' is seeing a gentle resurgence across the UK.**
More people are connecting with nature by learning to identify edible plants, turning it into a mindful outdoor hobby, often followed by delicious homemade treats.
- 4 The delightful trend of 'decorating letterboxes' for special occasions is adding a touch of cheer to neighbourhoods.**
From festive wreaths to seasonal adornments, homeowners are embracing this small but charming way to spread joy and create a welcoming entrance.
- 5 New research highlights the positive impact of 'spotting rainbows' on our daily mood.**
Even a brief glimpse of this natural phenomenon can trigger feelings of wonder and happiness, offering a welcome lift to an otherwise ordinary day.
- 6 The humble 'hot water bottle' is being championed as a timeless eco-friendly comfort item.**
Beyond its warmth, advocates point to its energy efficiency and ability to provide soothing relief without needing to heat an entire room.
- 7 A growing number of people are discovering the meditative benefits of 'watching fish in an aquarium'.**
The gentle, silent movement of aquatic life can be incredibly calming, providing a moment of peace and a visual escape from daily stresses.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with their shopping list, even if they know they've already memorised it?

ANSWER: ...ADDING ONE RANDOM, SILLY ITEM AT THE BOTTOM JUST FOR A GIGGLE.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'spot' on the sofa that they absolutely have to sit in for their evening telly. What's special about it?

ANSWER: ...IT'S THE ONLY SPOT WHERE THE BISCUIT CRUMBS ARE ALREADY PERFECTLY ARRANGED.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old childhood board game' that you thought was long gone, and it brings back a flood of memories?**
What's a classic game from your past that you've recently rediscovered or would love to play again? What makes it so special?

- **We all have those 'little quirks' when it comes to how we organise our kitchen cupboards – perhaps a specific shelf for mugs or a very particular way the tins face?**
What's your slightly unusual but essential kitchen cupboard organisation rule? Do you have a system that makes perfect sense to you, but might seem odd to others?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space-junk art installation' that orbits Earth, made up of tiny reflective objects designed to be visible from the ground at specific times.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Earth's gravity is slowly but surely pulling the moon closer to us, meaning one day the moon will crash into our planet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from outer space.
- The 'richest' soil in the world is found in the Amazon rainforest.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- Some types of bamboo can grow up to 3 feet in a single day, making it one of the fastest-growing plants on Earth.

On this day

Day 190 of the year, 175 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Cambodia); Christian Feast Day: Amandina of Schakkebroek (one of Martyrs of Southern Hunan); Christian Feast Day: Blessed Marija Petković; Christian Feast Day: Everilda. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Bon Scott, Scottish-Australian singer-songwriter (died 1980)
- 1975 — Isaac Brock, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1957 — Marc Almond, English singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Kiely Williams, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1956 — Tom Hanks, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1935 — Michael Williams, English actor (died 2001)
- 1964 — Courtney Love, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1959 — Jim Kerr, Scottish singer-songwriter and keyboard player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1943 — World War II: The Allied invasion of Sicily begins, leading to the downfall of Mussolini and forcing Hitler to break off the Battle of Kursk.
- 1961 — Greece becomes the first member state to join the European Economic Community by signing the Athens Agreement, which is later suspended in 1967 during the Greek junta.
- 1982 — Pan Am Flight 759 crashes in Kenner, Louisiana, killing all 145 people on board and eight others on the ground.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2002 — The African Union is established in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, replacing the Organisation of African Unity (OAU). The organization's first chairman is Thabo Mbeki, President of South Africa.
- 2006 — One hundred and twenty-five people are killed when S7 Airlines Flight 778, an Airbus A310 passenger jet, veers off the runway while landing in wet conditions at Irkutsk Airport in Siberia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1926 — Chiang Kai-shek accepts the post of commander-in-chief of the National Revolutionary Army, marking the beginning of the Northern Expedition to unite China under the rule of the Nationalist government.

- 1962 — Starfish Prime tests the effects of a nuclear explosion at orbital altitudes.
- 1986 — The New Zealand Parliament passes the Homosexual Law Reform Act legalising homosexuality in New Zealand.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 191 of the year, 174 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Mauritania); Christian feast day: Amalberga of Maubeuge; Christian feast day: Canute IV of Denmark; Christian feast day: Martyrs of Damascus. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2001 — Isabela Merced, American actress
- 1970 — John Simm, English actor
- 1982 — Alex Arrowsmith, American guitarist and producer
- 1951 — Cheryl Wheeler, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1998 — Angus Cloud, American actor (died 2023)
- 1945 — Virginia Wade, English tennis player and sportscaster
- 1942 — Sixto Rodriguez, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2023)
- 1959 — Sandy West, American singer, drummer and songwriter (died 2006)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2011 — Russian cruise ship Bulgaria sinks in the Volga River near Syukeyevo, Tatarstan, causing 122 deaths.
- 1995 — The NIOSH air filtration ratings update with the enactment of 42 CFR 84, previously published in the Federal Register. The new regulation includes rules governing the new N95 respirator standard.
- 2019 — The final Volkswagen Beetle rolls off the line in Puebla, Mexico; the last of 5,961 "Special Edition" cars will be exhibited in a museum.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 420 — Having usurped the throne of Emperor Gong of Jin, Liu Yu proclaims himself Emperor of the Liu Song dynasty.
- 1951 — Korean War: Armistice negotiations begin at Kaesong.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)